

CampusConnect Pitch Deck Milestone 1 - Startup Idea

1 The Idea

CampusConnect is a dual-purpose mobile application designed exclusively for university students within the same campus, integrating a marketplace for goods and services with a dating and social connection platform. The app fosters a trusted, campus-verified community to meet students' academic, economic, and social needs.

2 Target Market

- **Primary:** University students aged 18–25.
- **Geographic Focus:** Initially launching at a single Turkish university (pilot campus).
- **Market Size:** Over 7 million university students across Turkey in 2025, with projections indicating growth to approximately 7.5 million by 2035 [1].

3 What We Do

3.1 Marketplace Features

- Buy/sell textbooks, electronics, furniture, and dorm essentials.
- Rent equipment such as laptops, printers, calculators, and study tools.
- Offer tutoring services, online courses, and academic workshops.
- Exchange notes, study materials, and collaborative project resources.
- **New:** Group buying discounts for bulk purchases (e.g., textbooks or event tickets).
- **New:** Campus event ticket marketplace for student-organized events.

3.2 Dating and Social Features

- Connect with verified students from the same university.
- Campus-verified profiles to ensure safety and authenticity.
- Study date matching and group study session coordination.
- Event-based meetups, including campus clubs and social gatherings.
- **New:** Interest-based group chats for hobbies, sports, or academic interests.
- **New:** Anonymous icebreaker feature for shy users to initiate conversations.

4 Why This Combination?

- **Higher Engagement:** Dual-purpose app encourages daily use for both commerce and social interaction.
- **Trust Factor:** Campus verification ensures a safer environment for transactions and connections.

- **Network Effects:** Increased user base enhances the value of both marketplace and dating features.
- **Unique Positioning:** No competitor combines a campus-specific marketplace with dating/social features.
- **New:** Synergy between features (e.g., buy a textbook and arrange a study date with the seller).

5 Revenue Streams

- **Transaction Fees:** 5–8% commission on marketplace sales.
- **Premium Features:** Enhanced profiles, priority listings, and advanced matching filters.
- **Subscription Model:** Premium dating features (e.g., unlimited swipes, profile boosts).
- **Service Fees:** Verification badges, dispute resolution, and priority customer support.
- **New:** Sponsored campus events and advertisements from local businesses (e.g., cafes, bookstores).
- **New:** Partnership commissions from university-affiliated services (e.g., printing shops, student discounts).

6 Competitive Advantage

- **Campus-Only Focus:** Builds trust and safety compared to general platforms like Letgo or Tinder.
- **Dual Purpose:** Reduces the need for multiple apps, streamlining student life.
- **Local Network:** Same-campus focus enables easy meetups and transactions.
- **Student-Centric:** Tailored to student budgets, academic needs, and social preferences.
- **New:** Gamification features (e.g., badges for active users, rewards for frequent transactions).

7 Technical Feasibility

- **Background:** Developed by a Computer Engineering student with expertise in mobile app development.
- **Development Approach:** Mobile-first using React Native for cross-platform compatibility (iOS and Android).
- **MVP Timeline:** 3–4 months for core features.
- **Key Features:**
 - User authentication with campus email verification.
 - Real-time messaging and notifications.
 - Secure payment processing with integration of local payment gateways (e.g., PayU Turkey).
 - Matching algorithms for dating and study group formation.

- **New:** AI-driven recommendations for marketplace items and social matches.
- **New:** Push notifications for time-sensitive deals or event reminders.
- **New Requirements:**
 - Scalable backend using Node.js and MongoDB for user data and transactions.
 - GDPR-compliant data privacy measures for user trust [3].
 - Offline mode for limited functionality during poor connectivity.
 - Moderation tools to ensure a safe environment for social interactions.
 - Multi-language support to accommodate international students.

8 Use Cases

- **Marketplace Use Case 1: Textbook Exchange**
 - *Scenario:* A student needs a second-hand textbook for a course.
 - *Actions:* Searches the marketplace, finds a verified seller on campus, negotiates price via in-app chat, and completes the transaction with a secure payment.
 - *Outcome:* Saves money and arranges an in-person pickup at a campus location.
- **Marketplace Use Case 2: Group Buying**
 - *Scenario:* A group of students wants to buy textbooks in bulk for a discount.
 - *Actions:* Creates a group buy listing, invites classmates, negotiates with a seller, and splits the cost via the app.
 - *Outcome:* Students save money and build connections with peers.
- **Marketplace Use Case 3: Event Ticket Purchase**
 - *Scenario:* A student wants to attend a campus concert but tickets are sold out.
 - *Actions:* Browses the event ticket marketplace, finds a ticket from another student who can't attend, and purchases it securely.
 - *Outcome:* Attends the event without needing external platforms.
- **Dating Use Case 1: Study Date**
 - *Scenario:* A student wants a study partner for a challenging course.
 - *Actions:* Uses the study date matching feature, connects with a verified student in the same course, and arranges a study session at the library.
 - *Outcome:* Combines academic collaboration with social bonding.
- **Dating Use Case 2: Anonymous Icebreaker**
 - *Scenario:* A shy student wants to meet new people without revealing their identity initially.
 - *Actions:* Uses the anonymous icebreaker feature to start a conversation based on shared interests, then reveals their profile after building trust.
 - *Outcome:* Encourages participation from introverted users, increasing engagement.

- **Social Use Case: Interest-Based Group Chat**
 - *Scenario:* A student passionate about photography wants to connect with others.
 - *Actions:* Joins a photography group chat, engages with peers, and organizes a campus photo walk.
 - *Outcome:* Builds a community around shared interests.

9 Growth Strategy

1. **Launch:** Pilot at a single university with a targeted marketing campaign.
2. **Validate:** Collect user feedback through surveys and analytics to iterate features.
3. **Scale:** Expand to nearby universities, leveraging partnerships with student organizations.
4. **Long-term:** National expansion across Turkish universities, targeting 50,000 users within 2 years.
5. **New:** Collaborate with university administrations for official app endorsements.

10 Success Metrics

- **User Acquisition:** 1,000 users in the first 6 months.
- **Engagement:** 20% monthly active users.
- **Revenue:** Break-even by month 12.
- **Retention:** 40% user retention after 3 months.
- **New:** Average 3 transactions or social interactions per user per month.

11 Why Now?

- **Post-COVID Trends:** Students seek digital platforms for social and economic connections.
- **Economic Pressure:** Rising costs push students toward affordable second-hand goods and services.
- **Mobile-First Generation:** Students are accustomed to app-based solutions.
- **Market Gap:** No campus-specific platform exists in the Turkish market.
- **Growing Student Population:** The number of university students is expected to increase from approximately 7 million in 2025 to 7.5 million by 2035, expanding the potential user base [1].
- **Increasing Social Media Usage:** Social media users are projected to grow from 58.5 million in 2025 to approximately 72 million by 2035, indicating strong digital engagement [2].

12 Next Steps

1. **Market Research:** Conduct surveys to identify student pain points in commerce and social interactions.

2. **Competitive Analysis:** Analyze platforms like Letgo, Yemeksepeti, and Tinder for benchmarking.
3. **MVP Development:** Build core features (authentication, marketplace, messaging, matching).
4. **Beta Testing:** Launch with a small user group (100–200 students) for feedback.
5. **Funding:** Apply for TUBITAK support (up to 900,000 TRY) and explore angel investors.

"Connecting campus life through commerce and community"

References

- [1] Statista, "Number of Higher Education Students in Turkey by Degree, 2022/2023," <https://www.statista.com/statistics/1305722/turkey-number-of-higher-education-students-by-degree/>.
- [2] DataReportal, "Digital 2025: Turkey," <https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2025-turkey>.
- [3] European Union, "General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)," <https://gdpr.eu/>.